



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD WINGS

Wearable 4-Part Feathered Wing Set — Level Wings on a Stiff Top Beam, Y Straps

Level, feathered wings like the photo — one box, one afternoon.

AGES
4–12

BOXES
1 Medium Box

TIME
1–2 Hours

DIFF
Beginner *

PIECES
4 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

1 Medium Box (sides at least 18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm))

FINISHED SIZE:

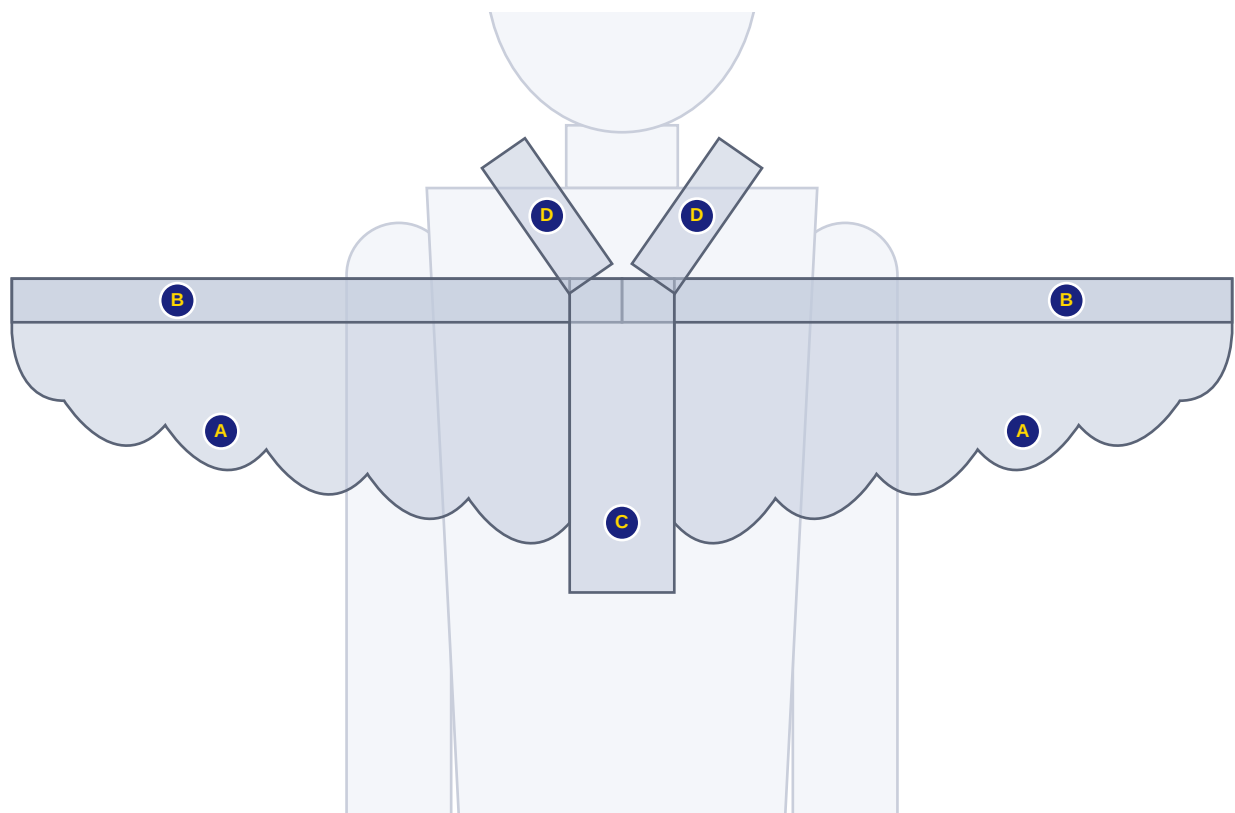
35" tip to tip × 9" tall (89 × 23 cm); each wing reaches about 12" past the shoulder

MISSION GOAL:

Build and wear the wings in the cover photo: two scalloped wings held level by a stiff box beam across the shoulder blades, a narrow back plate, two shoulder straps meeting in a Y, and brown feather paint.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD WINGS

Every part you cut, shown on the child at its real size, with the letter from its own cut-template page. The grey figure is only there for scale — measure your own child, never this drawing. Pieces that wrap round the head, an arm or a leg are shown as they look once wrapped, not laid flat.

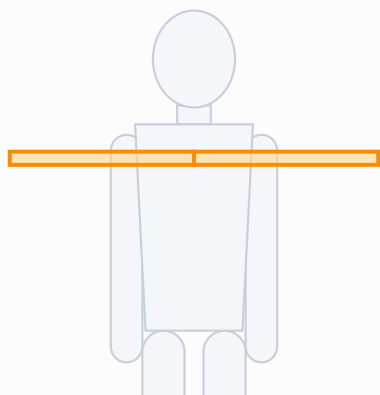


EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD			
A WING PANEL 16" × 7.75" (41 × 20 cm)	CUT ×2	B TOP BEAM 17.5" × 5.5" (44 × 14 cm)	CUT ×2
C BACK PLATE 3" × 9" (8 × 23 cm)	CUT ×1	D SHOULDER STRAP 1.5" × 14" (4 × 36 cm)	CUT ×2

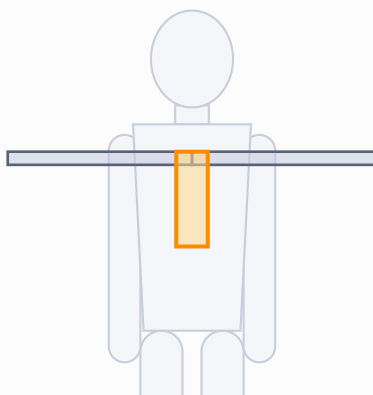
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

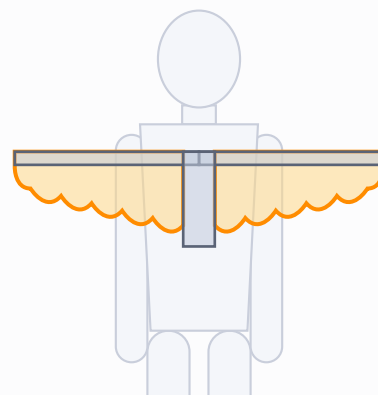
4 FOLD THE TOP BEAMS



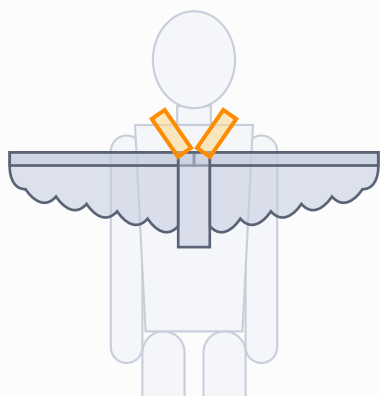
5 JOIN THE BEAMS TO THE BACK PLATE



6 HANG THE WING PANELS



7 FIT THE SHOULDER STRAPS





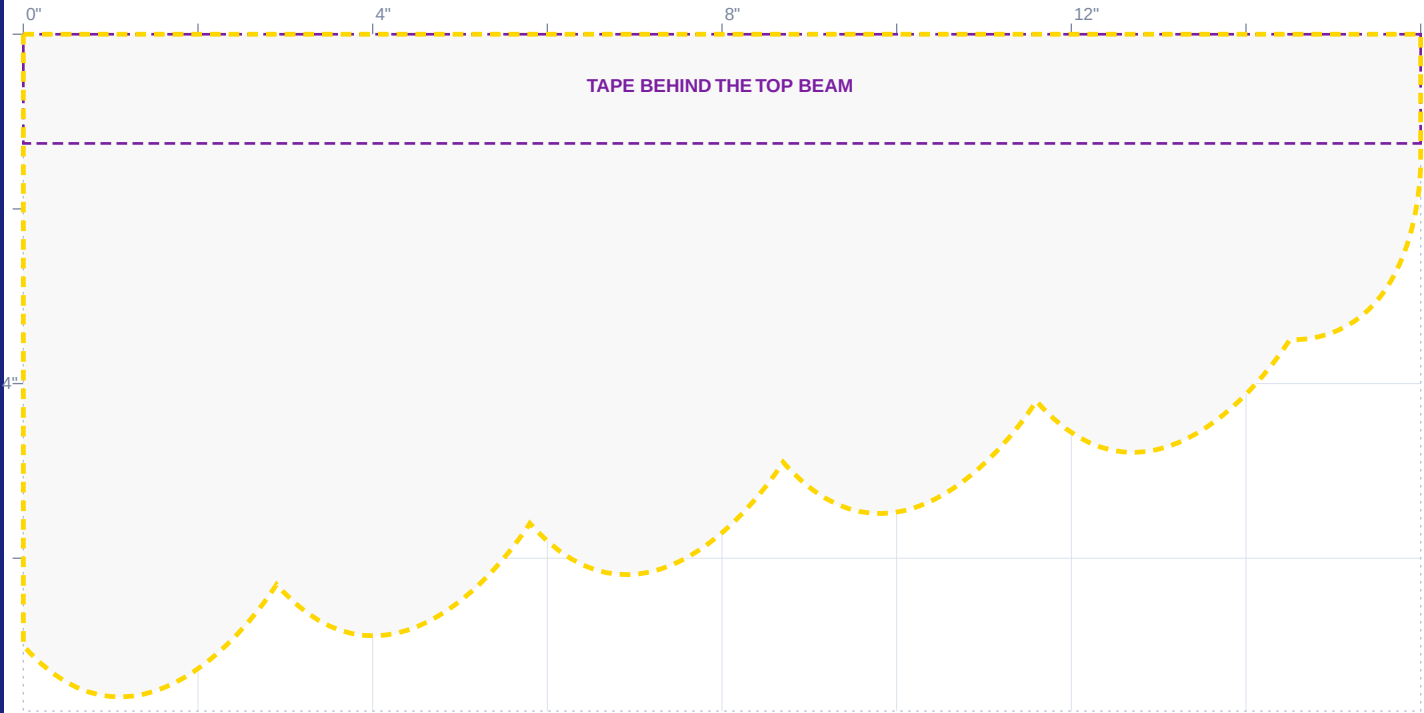
WING PANEL

16" × 7.75" (41 × 20 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

WING PANEL

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.5" (45% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 16" × 7.75" (41 × 20 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Top edge 16"; inner edge 7" down. At the tip mark 3.5" down, 1.5" in. Join the 2 marks with a light line, split it into 5 equal parts and draw a round bulge 1" below the line over each (trace a mug). Curve the tip up to the top corner. Flip it to trace the other wing.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

16" × 7.75" (41 × 20 cm)
Wing — straight top, 5 round lobes bulging OUT along the bottom, tip rounded up

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: Cut as a mirror pair. The top strip tapes behind the Top Beam



TOP BEAM

17.5" × 5.5" (44 × 14 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

TOP BEAM

x2

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

FOLD

FOLD

FOLD

FOLD — glue tab tucks inside

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 2.3" (42% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 17.5" × 5.5" (44 × 14 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

17.5" × 5.5" (44 × 14 cm)
Folds into a stiff square tube — this keeps the wings level

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Folds into a stiff square tube — this keeps the wings level



BACK PLATE

3" × 9" (8 × 23 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

BACK PLATE

x1

0"

4"

8"

3" × 9" (8 × 23 cm)

Narrow upright plate between the wings; the straps start at its top

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

PUNCH — poke a hole with a pencil

NOTE: Narrow upright plate between the wings; the straps start at its top



SHOULDER STRAP

1.5" × 14" (4 × 36 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

SHOULDER STRAP

0"

4"

8"

12"

+

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 0.8" × 7.6" (54% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 1.5" × 14" (4 × 36 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

1.5" × 14" (4 × 36 cm)

Over the shoulder, halfway between neck and shoulder tip

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

PUNCH — poke a hole with a pencil

NOTE: Over the shoulder, halfway between neck and shoulder tip

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD WINGS

CARDBOARD PIECES — 4 TOTAL (1 Medium Box (sides at least 18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm)))

×2 Wing Panel 16" × 7.75" <i>Cut as a mirror pair. The top strip tapes behind the Top Beam</i>	×1 Back Plate 3" × 9" <i>Narrow upright plate between the wings; the straps start at its top</i>
×2 Top Beam 17.5" × 5.5" <i>Folds into a stiff square tube — this keeps the wings level</i>	×2 Shoulder Strap 1.5" × 14" <i>Over the shoulder, halfway between neck and shoulder tip</i>

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- | | |
|-------------------------------|---|
| + 1 medium cardboard box | + Paint: mid brown, dark brown, light tan, cream and a little dark grey |
| + Scissors | + Paintbrushes (one wide, one small) |
| + Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY | + 2 lengths of ribbon or elastic, each as long as your child's arm |
| + Packing tape | + Hole punch (or a pencil point) |
| + Ruler + pencil | |

FUN FACT!

A wandering albatross has a wingspan of about 11 feet — wider than most cars are long.

CHALLENGE!

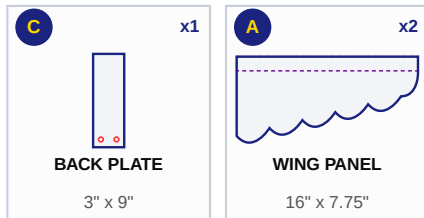
Flight school: practise a slow glide, a fast swoop and a perfect one-foot landing. Then decide what kind of bird you are.

1

STEP 1: MEASURE THE CHILD

Stand behind the child. The top of the wings runs across the top of the shoulder blades, about 3" (8 cm) below the bump at the base of the neck. The Back Plate hangs 9" (23 cm) down from there and should end above the waistband. Each wing reaches about 12" (30 cm) past the shoulder: 35" (89 cm) tip to tip.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

STEP 2: MARK OUT THE PIECES

Flatten the box. Mark out 2 of template A — draw the second one flipped over so the two mirror each other — then 2 of B, 1 of C and 2 of D, using the sizes on their template pages.

3

STEP 3: CUT OUT THE PIECES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut out every piece on its gold outline. On both A pieces the 5 lobes along the bottom bulge OUT, round like the ends of feathers — do not scoop them in. Punch the 2 ribbon holes at the bottom of C and the hole near one end of each D.

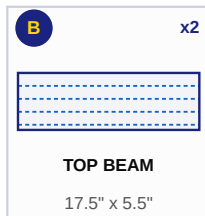
SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter.

4

STEP 4: FOLD THE TOP BEAMS

Score the 4 lines along each Top Beam and fold it into a square tube 1.25" (3 cm) on each side, with the 0.5" (1 cm) glue tab tucked inside. Tape the seam along its whole length and press every fold hard. This beam is what keeps the whole set level instead of drooping.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



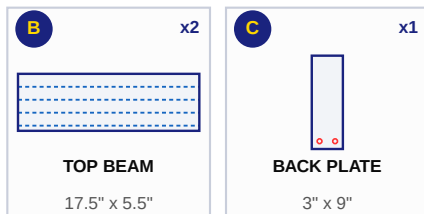
5

STEP 5: JOIN THE BEAMS TO THE BACK PLATE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay the Back Plate face down. Lay the two Top Beams end to end across its top so they meet on its centre line, top edges level with the top of the plate, and tape them down hard. You now have one straight, stiff bar from tip to tip with the narrow plate hanging from its middle.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

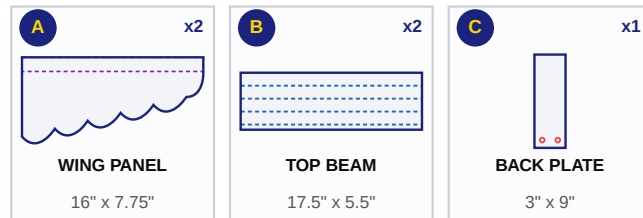


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STEP 6: HANG THE WING PANELS

Tape the top strip of each Wing Panel flat against the back face of a Top Beam (the face that will touch the child): inner edge against the side of the Back Plate, tip at the end of the beam. Tape along the whole beam. Lift the bar by its middle — both wings should hang level and barely bend.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



7

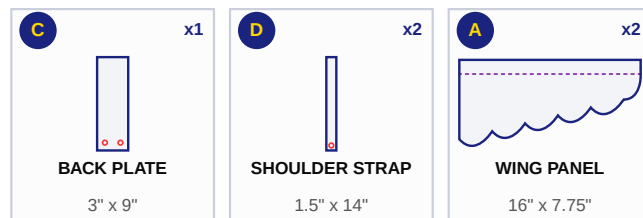
STEP 7: FIT THE SHOULDER STRAPS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the plain end of each Shoulder Strap to the back of the Back Plate at its top, so the two straps rise up and out in a Y. Put the wings on: each strap goes over a shoulder halfway between the neck and the tip of the shoulder. Tie a ribbon through the hole at the front end, run it under the armpit and tie it through the hole on that side at the bottom of the Back Plate, like a backpack.

SAFETY: Straps go over the shoulders, never near the neck.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

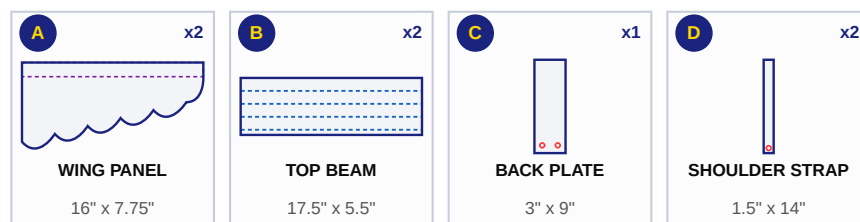


8

STEP 8: PAINT THE FEATHERS

Paint the outside of both Wing Panels. Base coat mid brown. Top third: a row of small U-shaped feathers right across, each 1.25" (3 cm) wide and 2" (5 cm) tall, outlined in cream with a dark brown middle. Below them: long feather strokes 0.5" (1 cm) wide and 3" (8 cm) long running down into every lobe, in dark brown, light tan and a little dark grey. Leave the Top Beams, Back Plate and Shoulder Straps plain cardboard, like the photo.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



9

STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK

Child wears them, walks through a doorway sideways and turns round. The wings sit level across the shoulder blades, the beam is straight and stiff, the lobes bulge out along the bottom, and the straps meet in a Y at the top of the plate. Compare to the cover photo — that is the standard.

SAFETY: The wings are wider than the child: practise doorways and stairs first.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

